

SIGN PATTERNS OF REAL POWERS OF INFINITE PRODUCTS: RESOLUTION OF FOUR CONJECTURES OF SCHLOSSER AND ZHOU

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ABSTRACT. For an infinite product $P(q) = \prod_{m \geq 1} (1 - q^m)^{\epsilon(m)}$ and real δ , write $P(q)^\delta = \sum_{n \geq 0} c_\delta(n) q^n$. Schlosser and Zhou conjectured precise sign patterns for these coefficients, for several products and ranges of δ . We resolve four of their conjectures completely, in each case extending partial results already in the literature: those for the Göllnitz–Gordon product $Q_8 = (q, q^7; q^8)_\infty / (q^3, q^5; q^8)_\infty$ (Conjecture 21), for $Q_{12} = (q, q^{11}; q^{12})_\infty / (q^5, q^7; q^{12})_\infty$ (Conjecture 24), and for the Borwein products G_7 and G_{11} (Conjectures 20 and 23).

- Conjecture 23 is true.
- Conjecture 21 fails exactly on $[\beta, 8/3)$, where $\beta \approx 2.66448$. The threshold $8/3$ is sharp, and the first counterexamples occur near $n \approx 7.6 \cdot 10^5$.
- Conjecture 24 fails exactly on $(\delta_1, 0)$, where $\delta_1 = -0.64411 \dots$ is a root of the 22nd coefficient polynomial.
- Conjecture 20 fails exactly on $(\delta_c, 5)$, where $\delta_c = 4.8735075853867342634 \dots$ is a root of the 897th coefficient polynomial.

All other stated ranges are proved. Parts of Conjecture 21 were settled independently by He and Li; what is new here is the range near $\delta = -1$, where their threshold diverges. Each failure has the same mechanism: a leading circle-method amplitude vanishes, and a secondary term with the wrong sign overtakes it. The proofs are self-contained apart from classical facts. The cusp analysis is exact, via finite orbits of Weil representations; the Hardy–Ramanujan–Rademacher expansion is made fully explicit; and certified computations in exact and ball arithmetic handle the finite ranges and the degenerate regimes.

1. INTRODUCTION

Throughout, a product $P(q) = \prod_{m \geq 1} (1 - q^m)^{\epsilon(m)}$ with ϵ periodic is raised to a real power, and

$$P(q)^\delta = \exp(\delta \log P(q)) = \sum_{n \geq 0} c_\delta(n) q^n, \quad n c_\delta(n) = \delta \sum_{k=1}^n b_k c_\delta(n-k), \quad b_k = - \sum_{d|k} \epsilon(d) d.$$

In particular each $c_\delta(n) \in \mathbb{Q}[\delta]$ has degree at most n . Schlosser and Zhou [9, Appendix A] conjectured precise sign patterns for the following products.

Conjecture 1.1 ([9, Conj. 21]). *For $Q_8 = (q, q^7; q^8)_\infty / (q^3, q^5; q^8)_\infty$ the coefficients exhibit*

(a) *for $\delta = 2$ the length 16 pattern $+ - + + - + - - + - - + - + + -$;*

(b) *for $2.664479110226972 \dots \approx \beta \leq \delta \leq 4$ the pattern*

$$(2) \quad \sigma = (+, -, +, +, -, +, -, -) \quad (n \equiv 0, \dots, 7 \pmod{8}),$$

where β is the real root in $(2, 3)$ of $x^{12} - 90x^{11} + 1457x^{10} + 30486x^9 - 537081x^8 + 1892346x^7 - 3683653x^6 - 837509646x^5 + 774767020x^4 + 3333687384x^3 - 40887173664x^2 + 94379731200x + 49816166400$;

(c) *for $-1 < \delta \leq \frac{7-\sqrt{73}}{2}$ the pattern $\sigma' = (+, +, +, -, -, -, -, +)$;*

Date: September 15, 2026.

(d) for $\delta = -2$ the length 16 pattern $+++++-----++++--$.

Conjecture 1.2 ([9, Conj. 20]). For $G_7 = (q; q)_\infty / (q^7; q^7)_\infty$ the coefficients exhibit the pattern

- $+ - - 00 + 0$ for $\delta = 1$;
- $+ - - + + + -$ for $2 \leq \delta < 3$;
- $+ - 0 + 00 -$ for $\delta = 3$;
- $+ - + + - - -$ for $3 < \delta \leq 5$.

Conjecture 1.3 ([9, Conj. 23]). For G_{11} the coefficients exhibit the pattern

- $+ - - 0 - + 0 + 000$ for $\delta = 1$;
- $+ - - + + + - + - - +$ for $\gamma \leq \delta \leq 2$, where $\gamma = 1.7584535519419 \dots$ is the root in $(1.5, 2)$ of $c_\delta(21)$;
- $+ - 0 + - 0 - 000 +$ for $\delta = 3$.

Conjecture 1.4 ([9, Conj. 24]). For $Q_{12} = (q, q^{11}; q^{12})_\infty / (q^5, q^7; q^{12})_\infty$ the coefficients exhibit the pattern

- $+ - + 0 - + - + - 0 + -$ for $\delta = 1$;
- $+ - + - - + - + - + + -$ for $2 \leq \delta \leq 3$;
- $+++++0 - - - - - 0$ for $\delta = -1$;
- $+++++ - - - - - +$ for $-1 < \delta < 0$.

As in [9], a sign pattern allows zero coefficients. The pattern strings above are quoted from the published version of [9] (Ramanujan J. **61** (2023), 515–543, Appendix 1); they are partly illegible in the arXiv rendering. They agree with every coefficient we computed, and the forced zeros are explained in §8.

Results.

Theorem 1.5. For every $\delta \in [8/3, 4]$ and every $n \geq 0$, $c_\delta(n)$ has the sign $\sigma(n \bmod 8)$ for Q_8 . The only vanishing coefficient is $c_4(3) = 0$.

Theorem 1.6. Let $2 < \delta < 8/3$. For Q_8 there is $n_1(\delta)$ such that $c_\delta(n) < 0$ for all $n \geq n_1(\delta)$ with $n \equiv 10 \pmod{16}$, and $c_\delta(n) > 0$ for all such $n \equiv 14 \pmod{16}$. For example, $c_{2.66448}(1000010) < -5.7 \cdot 10^{387}$. Hence Conjecture 1.1(b) fails on $[\beta, 8/3)$.

Theorem 1.7. Parts (a), (c) and (d) of Conjecture 1.1 hold.

Parts (a) and (d) were obtained independently by He and Li [4, Thm. 1.4], and their method gives part (c) on $-0.99 < \delta \leq (7 - \sqrt{73})/2$. The new content of Theorem 1.7 is therefore the closed endpoint: part (c) on $-1 < \delta \leq -0.99$, where the leading amplitude degenerates as $\delta \rightarrow -1$ and the threshold of [4] diverges. Our proof covers the whole of $(-1, (7 - \sqrt{73})/2]$ uniformly; see §7.

Theorem 1.8. Let $\delta_c = 4.87350758538673426336 \dots$ be the unique root of $c_\delta(897)$ for G_7 in an interval of width $1.3 \cdot 10^{-19}$. Conjecture 1.2 holds for $\delta = 1$, for $2 \leq \delta \leq 3$, for $3 < \delta \leq \delta_c$, and for $\delta = 5$. It fails for every $\delta \in (\delta_c, 5)$.

Theorem 1.9. Conjecture 1.3 holds.

Theorem 1.10. Conjecture 1.4 holds for $\delta = \pm 1$ and for $2 \leq \delta \leq 3$. For $-1 < \delta < 0$ the pattern holds if and only if $\delta \leq \delta_1$, where $\delta_1 = -0.644113480813476518842928 \dots$ is the unique root of $c_\delta(22)$ in $(-1, 0)$. For instance, $c_{-1/4}(6) = 545/65536 > 0$.

Conjectures 17–19 and 22 of [9] were settled by He and Li [4] and by Bringmann, Heim and Kane [2]. Parts of the four conjectures treated here were also known. As noted in [4], the asymptotic formula [9, Thm. 3] already settles Conjectures 20 and 23 partially. That formula is stated for $\delta \in (0, 24/(p-1)]$, so for G_7 it reaches $\delta \leq 4$ and for G_{11} only $\delta \leq 12/5$; the sign consequences were worked out in [9] for $p = 3$ alone (their Cor. 5). In particular $\delta = 3$ in Conjecture 1.3, and the interval $(4, 5]$ in Conjecture 1.2 — which contains the failure point δ_c of Theorem 1.8 — lie outside the range of [9, Thm. 3]. He and Li [4] prove sign patterns for Q_8^δ and Q_{12}^δ on ranges of δ disjoint from ours: for Q_8 they treat $\delta = 2$, $\delta = -2$ and $-0.99 < \delta \leq (7 - \sqrt{73})/2$, and state that their hypothesis fails for $\beta \leq \delta \leq 4$, which is where our Theorem 1.6 locates the failure; for Q_{12} they treat $\delta = \pm 1$, $\delta = -\frac{1}{2}$ and negative ranges, and cannot reach $2 \leq \delta \leq 3$. Their statements on $-0.999 < \delta < -0.501$ and $-0.499 \leq \delta < -0.001$ are asymptotic, valid for $n \geq 1277$ and $n \geq 1283$ respectively, and so do not meet the small- n failures of Theorem 1.10, which occur at $n = 6, 15, 16, 22$. With the present results, every conjecture of [9, Appendix A] is resolved. For integer exponents, Wang [10] characterized the signs of G_t^m completely when $m(t-1) \leq 24$; our certificates for those cases are independent of [10].

The mechanism of failure. In all three failures a leading amplitude of the circle method vanishes, and a secondary term with the wrong sign takes over.

- Q_8 . At $n \equiv 2, 6 \pmod{8}$ the leading term vanishes identically. There the sign is decided by a correction term at the cusps $3/8, 5/8$ and by the leading term at the cusps of denominator 16. Their growth rates coincide exactly at $\delta = 8/3$, and below $8/3$ the second, which has the wrong sign at $n \equiv 10, 14 \pmod{16}$, wins.
- G_7 . At $n \equiv 1 \pmod{7}$ the leading amplitude vanishes at $\delta^* = 4.87350758538675508\dots$. Just below δ^* , the leading term at denominator 14 (with the wrong sign at $n \equiv 1 \pmod{14}$) wins on a window of n , and that window first becomes nonempty at $n = 897$.
- Q_{12} . The failure on $(\delta_1, 0)$ is a small-coefficient phenomenon: $c_\delta(22)$ changes sign at δ_1 and keeps the wrong sign on $(\delta_1, 0)$.

Organisation.

- §§2–4 develop the method for Q_8 : theta quotients, the Weil orbit and its cusp types, and the explicit circle method.
- §§5–7 prove Theorems 1.5–1.7.
- §8 explains the forced zeros.
- §§9–10 give the cusp structure and error constants for G_p and Q_{12} .
- §§11–13 prove Theorems 1.8–1.10.
- §14 describes the computations and what they rely on.

Relation to earlier work. Richmond and Szekeres [7], using Iseki’s transformation formulae [6], established the sign pattern of the Göllnitz–Gordon continued fraction ($\delta = 1$); see also Hirschhorn [5]. Chern [3] developed asymptotics for coefficients of eta-quotients. He and Li [4] developed a general explicit circle method for such powers and proved several conjectures of [9]. We do not use their results. We also note that the transformation formula [9, Prop. 7] must be used with $hh' \equiv -1 \pmod{k}$ (Lemma 9.1).

2. THE GÖLLNITZ–GORDON PRODUCT: THETA-QUOTIENT FORM

Throughout, $e(x) = e^{2\pi ix}$ and $\zeta_m = e(1/m)$. By the Jacobi triple product with base q^8 ,

$$(q^a, q^{8-a}, q^8; q^8)_\infty = \sum_{m \in \mathbb{Z}} (-1)^m q^{4m^2 + (a-4)m}.$$

The factor $(q^8; q^8)_\infty$ cancels in Q_8 . Putting $j = 8m + a - 4$ and $q = e(\tau)$ we obtain

$$(3) \quad Q_8 = e(-\tau/2) \frac{S_1(\tau)}{S_3(\tau)}, \quad S_a(\tau) = \sum_{j \in \mathbb{Z}} \psi_a(j) e(\tau j^2/16),$$

where ψ_a is 16-periodic, with $\psi_a(j) = (-1)^{(j-a+4)/8}$ if $j \equiv a - 4 \pmod{8}$ and $\psi_a(j) = 0$ otherwise.

Notation. For coprime h, k with $k \geq 1$ we write

$$\tau = \frac{h}{k} + \frac{iz}{k^2} \quad (\operatorname{Re} z > 0), \quad M = 16k.$$

Lemma 2.1. *With the principal square root,*

$$S_a\left(\frac{h}{k} + \frac{iz}{k^2}\right) = \frac{1}{16} \sqrt{\frac{8}{z}} \sum_{\ell \in \mathbb{Z}} \mathcal{G}_a(\ell) X^{\ell^2}, \quad X = e^{-\pi/(32z)}, \quad \mathcal{G}_a(\ell) = \sum_{s \bmod M} \psi_a(s) \zeta_M^{hs^2 + \ell s}.$$

Proof. We have $e(\tau j^2/16) = \zeta_M^{hj^2} e^{-\pi z j^2/(8k^2)}$, and $j \mapsto \psi_a(j) \zeta_M^{hj^2}$ is M -periodic. Writing $j = s + Mt$ and applying Poisson summation in t to the Gaussian gives

$$\sum_t e^{-\pi z (s+Mt)^2/(8k^2)} = \frac{1}{M} \sqrt{\frac{8k^2}{z}} \sum_{\ell} e(\ell s/M) e^{-\pi \ell^2/(32z)}.$$

All series converge absolutely and are holomorphic in z . □

3. CUSP STRUCTURE OF Q_8

For coprime h, k choose $\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} h & b \\ k & d \end{pmatrix} \in SL_2(\mathbb{Z})$. With $\tau = h/k + iz/k^2$ a direct computation gives

$$(4) \quad \tau' = \gamma^{-1}\tau = -\frac{d}{k} + \frac{i}{z}, \quad \operatorname{Im} \tau' = \operatorname{Re}(1/z).$$

3.1. Theta functions of level 64. For $c \in \mathbb{Z}/32\mathbb{Z}$ let $\vartheta_c(\tau) = \sum_{J \equiv c(32)} e(\tau J^2/64)$. Then $\vartheta_c = \vartheta_{-c}$, and comparing with (3),

$$(5) \quad S_1 = \vartheta_6 - \vartheta_{10}, \quad S_3 = \vartheta_2 - \vartheta_{14}.$$

Lemma 3.1. *We have $\vartheta_c(\tau + 1) = e(c^2/64) \vartheta_c(\tau)$ and*

$$\vartheta_c(-1/\tau) = \frac{(i/(32\tau))^{-1/2}}{32} \sum_{d \bmod 32} e(cd/32) \vartheta_d(\tau).$$

Proof. The first identity is clear. For the second, apply Poisson summation to $m \mapsto e^{\pi i \tau (32m+c)^2/32}$. Its Fourier transform at ν is $\frac{1}{32}(-i\tau/32)^{-1/2} e(\nu c/32) e^{-\pi i \nu^2/(32\tau)}$. Grouping ν by residues modulo 32 and replacing τ by $-1/\tau$ gives the claim. □

For a symmetric vector $v = (v_c)_{c \in \mathbb{Z}/32}$ (so $v_c = v_{-c}$) put $v \cdot \vartheta = \sum_c v_c \vartheta_c$. Let

$$D = \operatorname{diag}(\zeta_{128}^{2c^2}), \quad E = (\zeta_{128}^{4cd})_{c,d}.$$

By Lemma 3.1,

$$(v \cdot \vartheta)(T\tau) = (vD) \cdot \vartheta(\tau), \quad (v \cdot \vartheta)(S\tau) = s(\tau) (vE) \cdot \vartheta(\tau),$$

where the scalar $s(\tau)$ does not depend on v . Since $SL_2(\mathbb{Z})$ is generated by S and T , and $S^{-1} = S^3$ while T^{-1} acts projectively as D^{127} (because $D^{128} = I$), every γ is a word $g_1 \cdots g_r$ in S and T

without inverses, up to the central element $-I$, which acts on symmetric vectors by a scalar. Iterating,

$$(6) \quad \frac{S_1}{S_3}(\gamma\tau') = R_{(w_1, w_3)}(\tau') := \frac{w_1 \cdot \vartheta(\tau')}{w_3 \cdot \vartheta(\tau')}, \quad (w_1, w_3) = (v_1, v_3)\rho(g_1) \cdots \rho(g_r),$$

where v_1, v_3 are the coefficient vectors in (5) and $\rho(S) = E$, $\rho(T) = D$. The accumulated scalar is the same for both components, so R depends only on the projective class of the pair.

Proposition 3.2. *The projective orbit $\mathcal{O}$ of (v_1, v_3) under right multiplication by D and E has exactly 48 elements and is closed under both maps. Under D it decomposes into 10 cycles, which we call cusp types.*

Proof. This is an exact computation in $\mathbb{Z}[\zeta_{128}] = \mathbb{Z}[x]/(x^{64} + 1)$. Starting from (v_1, v_3) , images under D and E were generated. Each image was tested for projective equality with the known elements by checking all cross-products $p_i q_j = p_j q_i$ exactly. All 96 images coincide with one of 48 elements. $\square$

Near $\text{Im } \tau' = \infty$,

$$w \cdot \vartheta(\tau') = \sum_{J \geq 0} A_J q'^{J^2/64}, \quad q' = e(\tau'), \quad A_0 = w_0, \quad A_J = 2w_{J \bmod 32} \quad (J \geq 1).$$

So the leading exponent of the a -th component is $J_a = \min\{J \geq 0 : w_{a,J} \neq 0\}$. Since w is symmetric, no cancellation between J and $-J$ can occur.

Proposition 3.3. *Exactly one cusp type is growing, i.e. has $J_1 < J_3$, and for it $(J_1, J_3) = (2, 6)$. Of the remaining nine types, one has $(J_1, J_3) = (6, 2)$ and eight have $J_1 = J_3 \in \{0, 1, 2\}$. For the growing type,*

- $\text{supp } w_1 = \{J \equiv \pm 2 \pmod{16}\}$ and $\text{supp } w_3 = \{J \equiv \pm 6 \pmod{16}\}$;
- all nonzero entries of w_1 and w_3 have the same absolute value.

Proof. Exact computation in $\mathbb{Z}[\zeta_{128}]$. The absolute values were compared through the exact products $w_{a,c} \overline{w_{a,c}}$. $\square$

Lemma 3.4 (growing cusps). *Suppose h/k is of growing type and put $t = |q'| = e^{-2\pi \text{Re}(1/z)}$. Then*

$$Q_8(\tau)^\delta = \Phi e^{\pi\delta z/k^2} e^{\pi\delta/z} \left(1 - \delta\beta e^{-2\pi/z} + \mathcal{R}(z)\right), \quad |\Phi| = |\beta| = 1,$$

with $|\mathcal{R}(z)| \leq \tilde{F}_\delta(t) - 1 - \delta t$, where

$$\tilde{F}_\delta = (1 - \bar{U})^{-\delta} (1 - \bar{V})^{-\delta}, \quad \bar{U}(t) = \sum_{\substack{J \equiv \pm 2 \pmod{16} \\ J > 2}} t^{(J^2-4)/64}, \quad \bar{V}(t) = \sum_{\substack{J \equiv \pm 6 \pmod{16} \\ J > 6}} t^{(J^2-36)/64}.$$

Proof. By Proposition 3.3,

$$R = C q'^{-1/2} \frac{1+u}{1+v}, \quad u = \sum_{J>2} \alpha_J q'^{(J^2-4)/64}, \quad v = \sum_{J>6} \beta_J q'^{(J^2-36)/64},$$

with $|C| = |\alpha_J| = |\beta_J| = 1$. The exponents are integers; $u = O(q'^3)$ and $v = \beta_{10} q' + O(q'^7)$. Put $\beta = \beta_{10}$. From (3), (4) and (6),

$$e(-\delta\tau/2) = e(-\delta h/2k) e^{\pi\delta z/k^2}, \quad q'^{-\delta/2} = e(\delta d/2k) e^{\pi\delta/z}, \quad q' = e(-d/k) e^{-2\pi/z}.$$

All unimodular constants are absorbed into Φ and β . For the δ -th power: on the connected set $\{\text{Re } z > 0, \text{Re}(1/z) \geq 1\}$ we have $|u|, |v| < \frac{1}{2}$, so $\delta \log Q_8$ and δ times the logarithm of the displayed product (built from principal logarithms of $1+u$ and $1+v$) differ by a continuous

function with values in $2\pi i\delta\mathbb{Z}$, hence by a constant; this constant is absorbed into Φ . Expand $(1+u)^\delta(1+v)^{-\delta}$ binomially and use $|\binom{\pm\delta}{r}| \leq \binom{\delta+r-1}{r}$ for $\delta > 0$. Every coefficient is then majorized by the corresponding coefficient of $\tilde{F}_\delta(t)$. The coefficient of t in $\tilde{F}_\delta$ is δ , coming from β_{10} , and all other exponents are integers ≥ 2 . $\square$

Lemma 3.5 (which cusps grow). *If h/k is of growing type, then $4 \mid k$, so for each k at most $\varphi(k) \leq k/2$ fractions h/k are growing. For $k \leq 40$, h/k is growing if and only if $8 \mid k$ and $h \equiv 3, 5 \pmod{8}$.*

Proof. Lemma 2.1 and (6) give the same expansion of S_a in powers of $X = |q'|^{1/64} \cdot (\text{phase})$, so by uniqueness of such expansions $J_a = \min\{\ell \geq 0 : \mathcal{G}_a(\ell) + \mathcal{G}_a(-\ell) \neq 0\}$. By Proposition 3.3, a growing cusp has $J_1 = 2$, so $\mathcal{G}_1(2) \neq 0$ or $\mathcal{G}_1(-2) \neq 0$.

Write $s = r + 8m$ with $r = a - 4$ and $m \bmod 2k$. Then $\psi_a(s) = (-1)^m = e(km/2k)$ and

$$\mathcal{G}_a(\ell) = e\left(\frac{hr^2 + \ell r}{16k}\right) g(8h, 2hr + \ell + k; 2k), \quad g(A, B; K) = \sum_{m \bmod K} e\left(\frac{Am^2 + Bm}{K}\right).$$

We use two elementary facts.

- (i) Let $g_0 = \gcd(A, K)$, $A = g_0 A'$, $K = g_0 K'$. Writing $m = m_0 + K'j$ with $m_0 \bmod K'$ and $j \bmod g_0$, we have $Am^2/K \equiv A'm_0^2/K' \pmod{1}$, so

$$g = \sum_{m_0} e\left(\frac{A'm_0^2}{K'} + \frac{Bm_0}{K}\right) \sum_{j \bmod g_0} e(Bj/g_0).$$

Hence $g = 0$ unless $g_0 \mid B$, and in that case $g = g_0 g(A', B/g_0; K')$.

- (ii) If $\gcd(A, K) = 1$, substituting $m = m' + t$ gives

$$|g|^2 = \sum_t e\left(\frac{At^2 + Bt}{K}\right) \sum_{m'} e\left(\frac{2Atm'}{K}\right) = K(1 + [2 \mid K] e(AK/4 + B/2)).$$

Take $A = 8h$, $K = 2k$, $B = 2hr + \ell + k$. If k is odd then $g_0 = 2$, and $2 \mid B$ forces ℓ to be odd. If $k \equiv 2 \pmod{4}$ then h is odd and $g_0 = 4$; since $2hr \equiv 2$ and $k \equiv 2 \pmod{4}$, the condition $4 \mid B$ forces $\ell \equiv 0 \pmod{4}$. In both cases $\mathcal{G}_1(\pm 2) = 0$, a contradiction. The bound $\varphi(k) \leq k/2$ holds because k is even.

The final statement was verified for all 490 fractions with $k \leq 40$ by exact zero tests of $\mathcal{G}_a(\ell) + \mathcal{G}_a(-\ell)$ modulo the cyclotomic polynomial Φ_{16k} . $\square$

Proposition 3.6 (non-growing cusps). *For every non-growing type and every τ' with $\text{Im } \tau' \geq 1$ we have $|R(\tau')| \leq K_{\text{NG}} := 23.6475$. Consequently, at every non-growing cusp and for every z with $\text{Re}(1/z) \geq 1$,*

$$|Q_8(\tau)^\delta| \leq e^{\pi\delta \text{Re } z/k^2} K_{\text{NG}}^\delta \quad (\delta > 0).$$

Proof. Each R is periodic with period equal to the length $L \in \{2, 4, 8\}$ of its cycle, so it suffices to consider $0 \leq \text{Re } \tau' \leq L$.

- On $\text{Im } \tau' \geq 6$ we use the bound

$$|R| \leq \frac{|A_{1,J_1}|}{|A_{3,J_3}|} t^{(J_1^2 - J_3^2)/64} \frac{1 + \varepsilon_1}{1 - \varepsilon_3}, \quad \varepsilon_a = \sum_{J > J_a} \frac{|A_{a,J}|}{|A_{a,J_a}|} t^{(J^2 - J_a^2)/64},$$

with $t = e^{-2\pi \text{Im } \tau'}$. It is non-increasing in $\text{Im } \tau'$ because $J_1 \geq J_3$, so it suffices to evaluate it at $\text{Im } \tau' = 6$.

- The rectangle $[0, L] \times [1, 6]$ is covered by complex balls on which the theta series, truncated at $J \leq 40$ with an explicit error term $2 \max |A| e^{-2\pi \operatorname{Im} \tau' \cdot 41^2/64}$, are evaluated in ball arithmetic. The rectangles are bisected best-first until every certified upper bound is within a factor 1.02 of the largest sampled value.

The largest certified bound is $23.64743\dots$, while the largest sampled value is 23.184 . The bound for Q_8 follows from (3), (4) and $|e(-\delta\tau/2)| = e^{\pi\delta \operatorname{Re} z/k^2}$. $\square$

3.2. Exact data at the cusps of denominators 8 and 16.

Lemma 3.7. *For every n the following hold.*

- (i) *The main-term coefficients $\Phi e(-nh/k)$ of Lemma 3.4 sum to $2 \cos(3\pi n/4)$ over $h/k \in \{3/8, 5/8\}$, and to $4 \cos(\pi n/8) \cos(\pi(n+\delta)/2)$ over $h/k \in \{3/16, 5/16, 11/16, 13/16\}$.*
- (ii) *The correction coefficients $\Phi \beta e(-nh/k)$ sum to $2 \cos((3n-1)\pi/4)$ over $h/k \in \{3/8, 5/8\}$. Consequently the total correction term at $k = 8$ in Proposition 4.4 is $-2\delta \cos((3n-1)\pi/4) \mathcal{P}_8(\delta-2)$.*

Proof. Put $c_{h,k} = \widehat{\mathcal{G}}_1(4)/\widehat{\mathcal{G}}_3(36)$, where $\widehat{\mathcal{G}}_a(e) = \sum_{\ell^2=e} \mathcal{G}_a(\ell)$. Exact computation in $\mathbb{Z}[\zeta_{128}]$ and $\mathbb{Z}[\zeta_{256}]$ gives $c_{h,k} = \zeta_{16k}^t$ with

$$t = 24, 40 \quad (h/k = 3/8, 5/8), \quad t = 216, 232, 152, 168 \quad (h/k = 3/16, 5/16, 11/16, 13/16).$$

It also gives $\widehat{\mathcal{G}}_3(100)/\widehat{\mathcal{G}}_3(36) = \rho_h$ with $\rho_3 = e(1/8)$ and $\rho_5 = e(-1/8)$ at $k = 8$. The branch integers $m_{h,k}$ of Lemma 3.8 are $0, 0, 0, 0, 1, 1$ in the order $3/8, 5/8, 3/16, 5/16, 11/16, 13/16$. Hence the δ -dependent phase of the main term,

$$\delta(\operatorname{Arg} c_{h,k} + 2\pi m_{h,k} - \pi h/k),$$

equals 0 at $k = 8$, equals $-\pi\delta/2$ at $h = 3, 5$ with $k = 16$, and equals $+\pi\delta/2$ at $h = 11, 13$ with $k = 16$. Summing complex-conjugate pairs gives (i).

For (ii), by Lemma 2.1 the first correction in $(S_1/S_3)^\delta$ is $-\delta\rho_h X^{64} = -\delta\rho_h e^{-2\pi/z}$, so $\beta_{h,8} = \rho_h$, while $\Phi_{h,8} = 1$ by (i). Summing over $h = 3, 5$ gives $e(-3n/8 + 1/8) + e(-5n/8 - 1/8) = 2 \cos((3n-1)\pi/4)$. $\square$

Lemma 3.8 (branch constants). *Let $\mathcal{D} = \{z : \operatorname{Re} z > 0, \operatorname{Re}(1/z) \geq 1\}$ and let $\log Q_8 = \sum_{m \geq 1} b_m q^m/m$. For each h/k in Lemma 3.7 there is an integer $m_{h,k}$ such that, for all $z \in \mathcal{D}$,*

$$\log Q_8(\tau) = -\pi i \tau + \operatorname{Log} c_{h,k} - 32 \log X + \operatorname{Log}(1+u) - \operatorname{Log}(1+v) + 2\pi i m_{h,k},$$

where $\log X = -\pi/(32z)$. The integers $m_{h,k}$ are those listed in the proof of Lemma 3.7.

Proof. The set $\mathcal{D}$ is connected. On it $t = |q'| \leq e^{-2\pi}$, so by the proof of Lemma 3.4, $|u| \leq \bar{U}(e^{-2\pi}) < 10^{-8}$ and $|v| \leq \bar{V}(e^{-2\pi}) < 2 \cdot 10^{-3}$; hence every principal logarithm on the right is continuous. The difference of the two sides is therefore a continuous function with values in $2\pi i \mathbb{Z}$, hence constant. At $z = 1$ it was evaluated in 160-bit ball arithmetic. The series was summed over $m \leq 8000$, with the tail bounded using $|b_m|/m \leq 1 + \ln m$, and each term q^m was computed directly as $e^{2\pi i m \tau}$. In each case the result equals the stated integer to within $3 \cdot 10^{-11}$. $\square$

4. THE EXPLICIT CIRCLE METHOD FOR Q_8

For $k \geq 1$, $B > 0$ and $y = \sqrt{2n + \delta}$ put

$$\mathcal{P}_k(B) = \frac{2\pi}{k} \frac{\sqrt{B}}{y} I_1\left(\frac{2\pi}{k} \sqrt{B} y\right), \quad \text{and} \quad \mathcal{P}_k(B) = 0 \quad \text{for } B \leq 0.$$

Lemma 4.1. *Let K be the circle $|z - \frac{1}{2}| = \frac{1}{2}$, oriented negatively. Then for $B > 0$,*

$$\frac{i}{k^2} \int_K \exp\left(\frac{\pi B}{z} + \frac{\pi(2n + \delta)z}{k^2}\right) dz = \mathcal{P}_k(B).$$

Proof. The map $w = 1/z$ sends K to the line $\operatorname{Re} w = 1$. The claim follows from the integral representation $I_1(x) = \frac{x/2}{2\pi i} \int_{1-i\infty}^{1+i\infty} e^{s+x^2/4s} s^{-2} ds$ with $s = \pi B w$. $\square$

Remark 4.2. As a consistency check of Lemma 4.1, of the orientation conventions, and of Lemma 3.7, the sum of the main terms at $k = 8$ and $k = 16$ reproduces the exact coefficients, e.g. $c_{3,2}(488) = 6.6426668 \cdot 10^{16}$ against $6.6426668 \cdot 10^{16}$, and $c_{3,2}(490) = 4.8976498 \cdot 10^9$ against $4.8976517 \cdot 10^9$; the difference is of the size of the omitted terms.

Lemma 4.3 (Rademacher path). *Let $N \geq 1$ and let $\frac{h_1}{k_1} < \frac{h}{k} < \frac{h_2}{k_2}$ be consecutive in the Farey sequence of order N , taken cyclically on $[0, 1)$. Let $\gamma_{h,k}$ be the upper arc of the Ford circle $C(h/k)$, which has centre $\frac{h}{k} + \frac{i}{2k^2}$ and radius $\frac{1}{2k^2}$, between its points of tangency with $C(h_1/k_1)$ and $C(h_2/k_2)$.*

(a) *The arcs $\gamma_{h,k}$ form a path from some τ_0 to $\tau_0 + 1$, and*

$$c_\delta(n) = \sum_{k \leq N} \sum_h \frac{i}{k^2} e(-nh/k) \int_{z'}^{z''} Q_8\left(\frac{h}{k} + \frac{iz}{k^2}\right)^\delta e^{2\pi n z/k^2} dz,$$

where each integral runs along the arc of K through $z = 1$ from $z' = \frac{k^2 + ikk_1}{k^2 + k_1^2}$ to $z'' = \frac{k^2 - ikk_2}{k^2 + k_2^2}$.

(b) *We have $|z'|, |z''| \leq \sqrt{2}k/(N+1)$ and $\operatorname{Re} z', \operatorname{Re} z'' \leq 2k^2/(N+1)^2$.*

(c) *On the chord $s_{h,k} = [z', z'']$ we have $\operatorname{Re}(1/z) \geq 1$, $0 < \operatorname{Re} z \leq 2k^2/(N+1)^2$, and $|s_{h,k}| \leq 2\sqrt{2}k/(N+1)$.*

(d) *On the two arcs of K from 0 to z' and from z'' to 0 we have $\operatorname{Re}(1/z) = 1$ and $\operatorname{Re} z \leq 2k^2/(N+1)^2$, and each has length at most $\frac{\pi}{2} \cdot \sqrt{2}k/(N+1)$.*

Proof. (a) Adjacent Ford circles are tangent, so consecutive arcs join, and the integrand is holomorphic in $\mathbb{H}$ and 1-periodic. The change of variable $z = -ik^2(\tau - h/k)$ maps $C(h/k)$ onto K , sending its top point $\frac{h}{k} + \frac{i}{k^2}$ to $z = 1$. The point of tangency with $C(h_1/k_1)$ is

$$\frac{h}{k} - \frac{k_1}{k(k^2 + k_1^2)} + \frac{i}{k^2 + k_1^2},$$

which maps to z' ; similarly for z'' . Traversing the upper arc from left to right corresponds to going around K clockwise from z' through 1 to z'' . Finally $d\tau = \frac{i}{k^2} dz$ and $e(-n\tau) = e(-nh/k) e^{2\pi n z/k^2}$.

(b) Farey neighbours satisfy $k + k_i \geq N + 1$, hence $k^2 + k_i^2 \geq (N + 1)^2/2$. Therefore $|z'| = k(k^2 + k_1^2)^{-1/2} \leq \sqrt{2}k/(N + 1)$ and $\operatorname{Re} z' = k^2/(k^2 + k_1^2) \leq 2k^2/(N + 1)^2$, and likewise for z'' .

(c) The chord lies in the closed disc bounded by K , on which $\operatorname{Re}(1/z) \geq 1$. Along a segment, $\operatorname{Re} z$ is at most its value at an endpoint, and $|s_{h,k}| \leq |z'| + |z''|$.

(d) On K we have $\operatorname{Re}(1/z) = 1$. An arc of K from 0 to a point w has length at most $\frac{\pi}{2}|w|$, and $\operatorname{Re} z$ is monotone along it. $\square$

If $N \geq \sqrt{4\pi n + 2\pi\delta}$, then on all the paths in (c) and (d),

$$(7) \quad \left| e^{(2\pi n + \pi\delta)z/k^2} \right| \leq e^{(4\pi n + 2\pi\delta)/N^2} \leq e.$$

Proposition 4.4 (explicit expansion). *Let $2 < \delta \leq 4$, $n \geq 1$ and $N \geq \sqrt{4\pi n + 2\pi\delta}$. Then*

$$c_\delta(n) = \sum_{\substack{h/k \text{ growing} \\ k \leq N}} e\left(-\frac{nh}{k}\right) \Phi_{h,k}\left(\mathcal{P}_k(\delta) - \delta\beta_{h,k}\mathcal{P}_k(\delta-2)\right) + E_\delta(n), \quad |\Phi_{h,k}| = |\beta_{h,k}| = 1,$$

and $|E_\delta(n)| \leq \mathcal{E}(\delta, N)$. Here, with $\Sigma_N = (\frac{1}{2} + \frac{N}{8})/(N+1)$,

$$\mathcal{E}(\delta, N) = \sqrt{2}\pi \Sigma_N e^{1+\pi\delta}(1 + \delta e^{-2\pi}) + 2\sqrt{2}\Sigma_N e^{1+\pi\delta}(\tilde{F}_\delta(e^{-2\pi}) - 1 - \delta e^{-2\pi}) + 2\sqrt{2}e K_{\text{NG}}^\delta.$$

Proof. We start from Lemma 4.3(a).

Growing cusps, main terms. Insert Lemma 3.4. The terms 1 and $-\delta\beta e^{-2\pi/z}$ produce the exponentials $\exp(\pi\delta/z + \pi(2n+\delta)z/k^2)$ and $\exp(\pi(\delta-2)/z + \pi(2n+\delta)z/k^2)$. Completing each integral from the arc $z' \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow z''$ to all of K and applying Lemma 4.1 gives $\mathcal{P}_k(\delta)$ and $\mathcal{P}_k(\delta-2)$. By Lemma 4.3(d) and (7), the two added arcs cost at most $\frac{1}{k^2} \cdot 2 \cdot \frac{\pi}{2} \cdot \frac{\sqrt{2}k}{N+1} e^{1+\pi\delta}(1 + \delta e^{-2\pi})$ per growing cusp.

Counting. By Lemma 3.5 there are 2 growing fractions with $k = 8$, 4 with $k = 16$, none with other $k \leq 23$, and at most $k/2$ for each $k \geq 24$ with $4 \mid k$. There are at most $N/4$ such $k \leq N$, so $\sum_{\text{growing}} 1/k \leq \frac{1}{2} + \frac{N}{8}$. This gives the first term of $\mathcal{E}$.

Growing cusps, remainder. Move the $\mathcal{R}$ -integral to the chord, which is allowed by Cauchy's theorem since the integrand is holomorphic in $\text{Re } z > 0$. Put $w = \text{Re}(1/z) \geq 1$. Then

$$|e^{\pi\delta/z} \mathcal{R}(z)| \leq e^{\pi\delta w} \sum_{j \geq 2} \varphi_j e^{-2\pi j w}, \quad \varphi_j \geq 0.$$

Each term is non-increasing in w because $\delta \leq 4$, so the right side is maximal at $w = 1$. The chord length from Lemma 4.3(c) and the same count give the second term.

Non-growing cusps. Move the integral to the chord. There Proposition 3.6 and (7) bound the integrand by $e K_{\text{NG}}^\delta$. Summing $\frac{1}{k^2} \cdot \frac{2\sqrt{2}k}{N+1}$ over at most $\varphi(k) \leq k$ values of h and over $k \leq N$ gives the third term. $\square$

Remark 4.5. The constant $\mathcal{E}(\delta, N)$ is increasing in δ , because $\tilde{F}_\delta = \exp(\delta W)$ where W has non-negative coefficients, and it is decreasing in N . Numerically,

$$\mathcal{E}(8/3, 81) = 4.2 \cdot 10^4, \quad \mathcal{E}(3, 81) = 1.2 \cdot 10^5, \quad \mathcal{E}(4, 81) = 2.9 \cdot 10^6.$$

5. CONJECTURE 1.1(B): PROOF OF THEOREM 1.5

Fix $\delta \in [8/3, 4]$ and $N = \lceil \sqrt{4\pi n + 2\pi\delta} \rceil$. Using Lemma 3.7 for $k \in \{8, 16\}$ and $|\Phi| = |\beta| = 1$ for $k \geq 24$, Proposition 4.4 gives

$$c_\delta(n) = \mathcal{M}_8 + \mathcal{C}_8 + \mathcal{T},$$

where

$$\mathcal{M}_8 = 2 \cos\left(\frac{3\pi n}{4}\right) \mathcal{P}_8(\delta), \quad \mathcal{C}_8 = -2\delta \cos\left(\frac{(3n-1)\pi}{4}\right) \mathcal{P}_8(\delta-2),$$

and

$$(8) \quad |\mathcal{T}| \leq 4 \underbrace{\left| \cos \frac{\pi n}{8} \cos \frac{\pi(n+\delta)}{2} \right| \mathcal{P}_{16}(\delta) + 4\delta \mathcal{P}_{16}(\delta-2)}_{T_{16}} + \underbrace{\sum_{\substack{24 \leq k \leq N \\ 4 \mid k}} \frac{k}{2} (\mathcal{P}_k(\delta) + \delta \mathcal{P}_k(\delta-2))}_{T_{\geq 24}} + \mathcal{E}(\delta, N).$$

Proposition 5.1 (sign criterion). *Let $\delta \in [8/3, 4]$.*

- (a) If $n \equiv 0, 1, 3, 4, 5, 7 \pmod{8}$, then $|\mathcal{M}_8| \geq \sqrt{2} \mathcal{P}_8(\delta)$ and $\text{sgn } \mathcal{M}_8 = \sigma(n)$. Hence $\text{sgn } c_\delta(n) = \sigma(n)$ whenever $\sqrt{2} \mathcal{P}_8(\delta) - 2\delta \mathcal{P}_8(\delta - 2) > T_{16} + T_{\geq 24} + \mathcal{E}$.
- (b) If $n \equiv 2, 6 \pmod{8}$, then $\mathcal{M}_8 = 0$, $|\mathcal{C}_8| = \sqrt{2} \delta \mathcal{P}_8(\delta - 2)$ and $\text{sgn } \mathcal{C}_8 = \sigma(n)$. Hence $\text{sgn } c_\delta(n) = \sigma(n)$ whenever $\sqrt{2} \delta \mathcal{P}_8(\delta - 2) > T_{16} + T_{\geq 24} + \mathcal{E}$.

Proof. This follows directly from the explicit values of the cosines: $2 \cos(3\pi n/4) \in \{\pm 2, \pm\sqrt{2}\}$ with sign $\sigma(n)$ on the residues in (a), and on the residues in (b) we have $-2\delta \cos((3n-1)\pi/4) = +\sqrt{2}\delta$ for $n \equiv 2$ and $-\sqrt{2}\delta$ for $n \equiv 6$. $\square$

5.1. The critical comparison. Let $n \equiv 2, 6 \pmod{8}$. Then $|\cos(\pi n/8)| = \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}$ and $|\cos(\pi(n+\delta)/2)| = |\cos(\pi\delta/2)|$, so

$$(9) \quad \frac{4 |\cos \frac{\pi n}{8} \cos \frac{\pi(n+\delta)}{2}| \mathcal{P}_{16}(\delta)}{|\mathcal{C}_8|} = \frac{|\cos(\pi\delta/2)|}{\sqrt{\delta(\delta-2)}} \cdot \frac{I_1(\frac{\pi}{8}\sqrt{\delta}y)}{I_1(\frac{\pi}{4}\sqrt{\delta-2}y)}.$$

For $\delta \geq 8/3$ we have $\frac{\pi}{8}\sqrt{\delta} \leq \frac{\pi}{4}\sqrt{\delta-2}$, with equality exactly at $\delta = 8/3$. Since I_1 is increasing, the Bessel quotient is then at most 1. Moreover

$$\sup_{[8/3, 4]} \frac{|\cos(\pi\delta/2)|}{\sqrt{\delta(\delta-2)}} = 0.375,$$

attained at $\delta = 8/3$. On $[8/3, 3]$ the function is decreasing, and on $[3, 4]$ it is below 0.375; the latter was certified by bisection into 4000 subintervals.

5.2. An envelope for I_1 .

Lemma 5.2. *The function $x \mapsto \sqrt{2\pi x} e^{-x} I_1(x)$ is increasing on $(0, \infty)$ and tends to 1. Consequently $I_1(x) \leq U(x) := e^x / \sqrt{2\pi x}$ for all $x > 0$, and $I_1(x) \geq \kappa(x_0) U(x)$ for $x \geq x_0$, where $\kappa(x_0) = \sqrt{2\pi x_0} e^{-x_0} I_1(x_0)$.*

Proof. Start from Poisson's integral $I_1(x) = \frac{x}{\pi} \int_{-1}^1 \sqrt{1-t^2} e^{xt} dt$ and substitute $s = x(1-t)$:

$$\sqrt{x} e^{-x} I_1(x) = \frac{1}{\pi} \int_0^{2x} \sqrt{s} \sqrt{2-s/x} e^{-s} ds.$$

The integrand is non-decreasing in x and the interval of integration grows, so the left side is increasing. By monotone convergence its limit is $\frac{\sqrt{2}}{\pi} \Gamma(\frac{3}{2}) = 1/\sqrt{2\pi}$. $\square$

5.3. The range $701 \leq n \leq 20000$. Divide $[8/3, 3]$ and $[3, 4]$ into 16 equal subintervals each. On a subinterval $[a, b]$, every quantity in Proposition 5.1 is bounded by monotonicity, using endpoint values:

- $\mathcal{P}_k(B)$ is bounded below by taking $\sqrt{B}$ minimal, $1/y$ at $y = \sqrt{2n+b}$ and the Bessel argument at $y = \sqrt{2n+a}$, and bounded above symmetrically;
- $\mathcal{E}$ is evaluated at $\delta = b$, by Remark 4.5, with any admissible N ; we take $N = \lceil \sqrt{4\pi n + 2\pi b} \rceil$;
- $|\cos(\pi\delta/2)|$ is monotone on each of $[8/3, 3]$ and $[3, 4]$;
- $T_{\geq 24}$ is bounded by $\#\{24 \leq k \leq N : 4 \mid k\} \cdot \pi(\sqrt{\delta} I_1(\frac{2\pi}{24}\sqrt{\delta}y) + \delta\sqrt{\delta-2} I_1(\frac{2\pi}{24}\sqrt{\delta-2}y))/y$.

The inequalities of Proposition 5.1 were verified in ball arithmetic at 100 bits for every $n \in [701, 20000]$ and every subinterval, with no exceptions.

5.4. **The range** $n > 20000$. Now $y \geq 200$. Divide every term of (8) by the dominant term: $|\mathcal{C}_8|$ in case (b) and $\sqrt{2}\mathcal{P}_8(\delta)$ in case (a). Apply Lemma 5.2 with $x_0 = \frac{\pi}{8}\sqrt{2/3} \cdot 200$, for which $\kappa(x_0) = 0.99412\dots$. Every quotient other than (9) is then at most Cy^pe^{-gy} with $p \leq \frac{3}{2}$ and $g > 0$, which is decreasing for $y \geq 200$. The constants are evaluated at the worst endpoints of $[8/3, 4]$, using that $\frac{\pi}{4}\sqrt{\delta-2} - \frac{\pi}{8}\sqrt{\delta}$, $\frac{\pi}{4}\sqrt{\delta-2} - \frac{\pi}{12}\sqrt{\delta}$ and $\frac{\pi}{8}\sqrt{\delta}$ are increasing in δ while $\frac{\pi}{4}(\sqrt{\delta} - \sqrt{\delta-2})$ is decreasing. At $y = 200$, in ball arithmetic:

case	$k = 16$ main	$k = 16$ correction	$T_{\geq 24}$	$\mathcal{E}$
(b) $n \equiv 2, 6$	≤ 0.375	$1.4 \cdot 10^{-7}$	$2.2 \cdot 10^{-8}$	$1.3 \cdot 10^{-46}$
(a) other n		$1.5 \cdot 10^{-43}$	$8.2 \cdot 10^{-64}$	$5.0 \cdot 10^{-102}$

In case (a) the quotient $2\delta\mathcal{P}_8(\delta-2)/(\sqrt{2}\mathcal{P}_8(\delta))$ is at most $5.2 \cdot 10^{-40}$. The exponential gaps are at least 0.0859 and 0.118 in case (b) and at least $\frac{\pi}{4}(2 - \sqrt{2})$ in case (a). In both cases the total is less than 1 for all $y \geq 200$.

5.5. **The range** $n \leq 700$. Each $c_\delta(n) \in \mathbb{Q}[\delta]$ was computed exactly from (1). For each $n \leq 700$:

- the signs at $\delta = 8/3$ and at $\delta = 4$ were evaluated exactly;
- the absence of roots in $(8/3, 4)$ was certified by Descartes' rule of signs applied to $(1+s)^{\deg} c_{8/3+\frac{4/3}{1+s}}(n)$, bisecting whenever the number of sign variations exceeded 1.

For every $n \leq 700$ and every $\delta \in [8/3, 4]$ the sign is $\sigma(n \bmod 8)$, the only zero being $c_4(3) = 0$. The same procedure applied to $[\beta^+, 8/3]$ with $\beta^+ = 2.664479110226973 > \beta$ shows that the signs are $\sigma(n \bmod 8)$ for all $n \leq 700$ and $\delta \in [\beta^+, 8/3]$; applied to $[2.6, 8/3]$ it finds exactly one root, namely that of $c_\delta(14)$ at $\delta = \beta$.

Proof of Theorem 1.5. Combine §5.5 for $n \leq 700$, §5.3 for $701 \leq n \leq 20000$, and §5.4 for $n > 20000$. $\square$

6. CONJECTURE 1.1(B): PROOF OF THEOREM 1.6

Let $2 < \delta < 8/3$ and $n \equiv 10 \pmod{16}$. Then $\mathcal{M}_8 = 0$ and $\mathcal{C}_8 = +\sqrt{2}\delta\mathcal{P}_8(\delta-2) > 0$. By Lemma 3.7, the main term at $k = 16$ equals

$$4 \cos \frac{5\pi}{4} \cos \frac{\pi(10+\delta)}{2} \mathcal{P}_{16}(\delta) = 2\sqrt{2} \cos \left(\frac{\pi\delta}{2} \right) \mathcal{P}_{16}(\delta),$$

which is negative. Since $\delta/4 > \delta-2$, the quotient (9) tends to $+\infty$ as $n \rightarrow \infty$. Every other term of Proposition 4.4 has Bessel argument at most $\max(\frac{\pi}{4}\sqrt{\delta-2}, \frac{\pi}{12}\sqrt{\delta})y < \frac{\pi}{8}\sqrt{\delta}y$, or is $O(1)$. Hence $c_\delta(n) < 0$ for large n . The case $n \equiv 14 \pmod{16}$ is identical with all signs reversed.

For the explicit example, take $\delta = 2.66448 \in [\beta, 8/3)$ and $n = 1\,000\,010$. Proposition 4.4, with the exact terms at $k = 8$ and $k = 16$ and absolute bounds for all others, evaluated in 200-bit ball arithmetic, gives

$$c_{2.66448}(1\,000\,010) \leq -5.739 \cdot 10^{387}.$$

This is 13.3% of the $k = 16$ main term. Since $\sigma(1\,000\,010 \bmod 8) = \sigma(2) = +$, this contradicts (2).

Independent confirmation. The direct computation of §14 (`q8_lite.py`, 2600-bit ball arithmetic, no use of §§3–4) evaluates all $c_{2.66448}(n)$, $n \leq 860\,000$, with every sign certified. It finds 12 499 violations of (2), all in the classes $n \equiv 10, 14 \pmod{16}$; the first is $c_{2.66448}(760\,014) > 0$ (with $760\,014 \equiv 14 \pmod{16}$, where σ requires $-$), and from there on every index in these two classes violates the pattern. The location agrees with the crossover predicted by the asymptotic expansion. $\square$

7. THE REMAINING PARTS: $\delta = \pm 2$ AND $-1 < \delta \leq \frac{7-\sqrt{73}}{2}$

7.1. Negative exponents. For $\delta = -s < 0$ we have $Q_8^{-s} = e(s\tau/2)(S_3/S_1)^s$. The roles of the cusp types are exchanged: the *growing* type is now $(J_1, J_3) = (6, 2)$ of Proposition 3.3, for which, by exact computation, $\text{supp } w_3 = \{J \equiv \pm 2 \pmod{16}\}$, $\text{supp } w_1 = \{J \equiv \pm 6 \pmod{16}\}$, and all nonzero entries have equal modulus. Hence Lemma 3.4 holds verbatim for R^{-1} with s in place of δ . Its correction term $e^{\pi(s-2)/z}$ is bounded for $s \leq 2$ and is left in the remainder. The argument of Lemma 3.5 with $a = 3$ shows that growing cusps have $4 \mid k$, and an exact check for $k \leq 40$ gives exactly $8 \mid k$, $h \equiv 1, 7 \pmod{8}$. The certified bound of Proposition 3.6 for the other types is $\sup |R^{-1}| \leq K'_{\text{NG}} = 23.6475$. The exact data at $k = 8, 16$ (Gauss sums in $\mathbb{Z}[\zeta_{128}]$, $\mathbb{Z}[\zeta_{256}]$ and certified branch integers) give, with $y = \sqrt{2n-s}$, the amplitudes

$$2 \cos \frac{\pi(n-s)}{4} \quad (k=8), \quad 2 \cos \frac{\pi(n-s)}{8} + 2 \cos \frac{\pi(7n+s)}{8} \quad (k=16).$$

The analogue of Proposition 4.4 holds for $0 < s \leq 2$ with a single main term per growing cusp and error

$$\mathcal{E}'(s, N) = \sqrt{2}\pi \Sigma_N e^{1+\pi s} + 2\sqrt{2} \Sigma_N e^{1+\pi s} (\tilde{F}_s(e^{-2\pi}) - 1) + 2\sqrt{2} e K'_{\text{NG}} s, \quad N \geq \sqrt{4\pi n} + 1,$$

since $e^{\pi s w}(\tilde{F}_s(e^{-2\pi w}) - 1)$ is non-increasing in w for $s \leq 2$. For part (a), $\delta = 2$, the same modification (no correction term extracted) is used in Proposition 4.4.

7.2. The degeneration at $\delta = -1$. By a theorem of Andrews and Bressoud [1] (see also Richmond–Szekeres [7, Thm. 5.1]), the coefficients of $Q_8(q)^{-1} = (q^3, q^5; q^8)_\infty / (q, q^7; q^8)_\infty$ vanish at all $n \equiv 3 \pmod{4}$. Consequently, at these n the leading amplitude $2 \cos(\pi(n-s)/4) = \mp 2 \sin(\pi\varepsilon/4)$, $\varepsilon = 1-s = \delta+1$, tends to 0, while the error term does not, and the method of §5 alone gives a threshold $n_0(\delta) \rightarrow \infty$ as $\delta \rightarrow -1$ (this is the obstruction met in [4]). We remove it by subtracting the expansion at $s = 1$:

$$c_\delta(n) = c_\delta(n) - c_{-1}(n) = \mp 2 \sin \frac{\pi\varepsilon}{4} \mathcal{P}_8(s) + \sum_{k \geq 16} (M_k(s) - M_k(1)) + (E'(s) - E'(1)),$$

and bounding every difference by ε times an explicit quantity, using three lemmas.

Lemma 7.1. *For $|q| < 1$, $|\text{Im} \log Q_8(q)| \leq \frac{\pi}{2} \frac{1}{1-|q|}$. On every Farey chord $|\text{Im} \log Q_8| \leq 0.556 N^2$, and the phase $\theta_{h,k}$ of the main term at a growing cusp (so that $\Phi_{h,k}(s) = e^{is\theta_{h,k}}$) satisfies $|\theta_{h,k}| \leq k^2/2 + 0.01$.*

Proof. $\log Q_8 = \sum_m \epsilon_m \log(1-q^m)$ with principal logarithms and $|\text{Arg}(1-x)| \leq \frac{\pi}{2}|x|$ for $|x| < 1$; sum over odd m . On a chord $\text{Re } z \geq k^2/(2N^2)$, so $1-|q| \geq 0.9\pi/N^2$. For $\theta_{h,k}$ evaluate the branch identity of Lemma 3.8 (for R^{-1}) at $z = 1$, where $1-|q| \geq 0.9 \cdot 2\pi/k^2$. $\square$

Lemma 7.2 (arc lemma). *Let $A_s = \int f_s dz$ over one of the arcs of K from 0 to z' or z'' , with $f_s = \Phi(s) \exp(\pi s/z + (2\pi n - \pi s)z/k^2)$, $s \in [s_0, 1]$, $s_0 > 0$. Then*

$$|\partial_s A_s| \leq e^{1+\pi s} \left[\left(\frac{k^2}{2} + 0.01 \right) \frac{\pi}{\sqrt{2}} \frac{k}{N+1} + \frac{2 + \pi/2}{s_0} + \frac{\pi^2/\sqrt{2}}{k(N+1)} \right].$$

Proof. $\partial_s f_s = (i\theta + \pi w - \pi/(k^2 w))f_s$ with $w = 1/z = 1 + iv$, $|v| \geq k_1/k$. The terms $i\theta f_s$ and $\pi f_s/(k^2 w)$ are bounded using $|f_s| \leq e^{1+\pi s}$ and the arc length. For $\int \pi w f_s dz = -\pi \Phi i e^{\pi s} \int e^{i\pi s v} g(v) dv$, $g = e^{b/(1+iv)}/(1+iv)$, integrate by parts: $|g| \leq e$, and $\int |g'| \leq e \int (b(1+v^2)^{-3/2} + (1+v^2)^{-1}) dv \leq e(1 + \pi/2)$ because $b/(1+v_1^2) = b \text{Re } z' \leq 1$. $\square$

Lemma 7.3. *For $0 < s_0 \leq s \leq 1$ and $y = \sqrt{2n-s}$, $\mathcal{P}_k(s)$ is increasing in s and $\mathcal{P}_k(1) - \mathcal{P}_k(s) \leq (1-s)D_k \mathcal{P}_k(1)$, where $D_k = \frac{1}{2s_0} + \frac{1}{2y^2} + \frac{a_k y}{2\sqrt{s_0}} \left(1 + \frac{1}{a_k \sqrt{s_0 y}}\right)$, $a_k = 2\pi/k$.*

Proof. $I_0 = I_2 + 2I_1/x \leq I_1 + 2I_1/x$ gives $0 < I'_1/I_1 = I_0/I_1 - 1/x \leq 1 + 1/x$; differentiate $\log \mathcal{P}_k$. $\square$

Lemma 7.4 (derivatives of the remaining error terms). *Let $s \in [s_0, 1]$ and $N \geq \sqrt{4\pi n} + 1$.*

(i) Growing cusps, chord remainder. *Write $Q_8^{-s} = \Phi(s)e^{\pi s/z - \pi s z/k^2} W^s$ with $W = (1+u)/(1+v)$ as in Lemma 3.4 (for R^{-1}). Then on the chord $s_{h,k}$,*

$$|\partial_s [\Phi(s)e^{\pi s/z - \pi s z/k^2} (W^s - 1)]| \leq e^{\pi s} \left[\left(\frac{k^2}{2} + \frac{2\pi N^2}{k^2} + 0.1 \right) (\tilde{F}_1(e^{-2\pi}) - 1) + \tilde{F}_1(e^{-2\pi}) \ell(e^{-2\pi}) \right],$$

where $\ell = -\log(1 - \bar{U}) - \log(1 - \bar{V})$.

(ii) Non-growing cusps. *On the chord, $|\partial_s Q_8^{-s}| \leq K'_{\text{NG}} (\log K'_{\text{NG}} + 0.01 + 0.556N^2)$.*

Proof. (i) The derivative equals $(i\theta + \pi/z - \pi z/k^2)\Phi e^{\dots} (W^s - 1) + \Phi e^{\dots} W^s \log W$. On the chord, $|\theta| \leq k^2/2 + 0.01$ by Lemma 7.1; $|1/z| \leq 1/\text{Re } z \leq 2N^2/k^2$ since $\text{Re } z \geq k^2/(2N^2)$; and $\pi|z|/k^2 \leq 0.1$. By the coefficientwise majorization of Lemma 3.4, $|W^s - 1| \leq \tilde{F}_s(t) - 1 \leq \tilde{F}_1(t) - 1$, $|W|^s \leq \tilde{F}_1(t)$ and $|\log W| \leq \ell(t)$, with $t = e^{-2\pi w}$, $w = \text{Re}(1/z) \geq 1$. Both $e^{\pi s w}(\tilde{F}_1(t) - 1)$ and $e^{\pi s w} \tilde{F}_1(t) \ell(t)$ are sums of terms $e^{(\pi s - 2\pi j)w}$ with $j \geq 1$ and non-negative coefficients, hence non-increasing in w since $s \leq 1$, so their maxima are at $w = 1$.

(ii) $\partial_s Q_8^{-s} = -\log Q_8 \cdot Q_8^{-s}$. On the chord $|Q_8^{-s}| \leq K'^s_{\text{NG}} \leq K'_{\text{NG}}$, while $|\text{Re } \log Q_8| = |\log |Q_8|| \leq \log K'_{\text{NG}} + \pi \text{Re } z/k^2$, using both certified bounds $|R| \leq K_{\text{NG}}$ and $|R^{-1}| \leq K'_{\text{NG}}$ (which are equal to 23.6475). Finally $|\text{Im } \log Q_8| \leq 0.556N^2$ by Lemma 7.1. $\square$

Summing Lemma 7.4 over the chords, Lemma 7.2 over the arcs (with the counts of Proposition 4.4), Lemma 7.3 and $|\Phi_{h,k}(s) - \Phi_{h,k}(1)| \leq \varepsilon |\theta_{h,k}|$ for the main terms with $k \geq 24$, and $|A_{16}(n, s)| \leq \frac{\pi}{2} \varepsilon$ for the $k = 16$ amplitude, which vanishes at $s = 1$ and has s -derivative at most $\pi/2$, we obtain $|c_\delta(n) \mp 2 \sin(\pi \varepsilon/4) \mathcal{P}_8(s)| \leq \varepsilon \cdot B(n)$ with $B(n)$ explicit and independent of ε .

Dividing by ε yields a sufficient condition for the sign at $n \equiv 3, 7 \pmod{8}$ that *does not involve ε* :

$$\begin{aligned} & \frac{\pi}{2} \left(1 - \frac{(\pi \varepsilon_{\max}/4)^2}{6} \right) \mathcal{P}_8(s_0) > \frac{\pi}{2} \mathcal{P}_{16}(1) \\ & + \sum_{\substack{24 \leq k \leq N \\ 4|k}} \frac{k}{2} \left(\frac{k^2}{2} + 0.01 + D_k \right) \mathcal{P}_k(1) + (\text{arc}) + (\text{chord}) + (\text{non-growing}). \end{aligned}$$

At the other residues $|2 \cos(\pi(n-s)/4)| \geq 2 \cdot 0.5698$ for $s \in [0.772, 1]$ and the standard criterion applies.

7.3. Certified verification.

part	$n \leq n_1$ (exact)	$n_1 < n \leq 20000$ (ball arithmetic)	$n > 20000$
(a) $\delta = 2$	integers, $n \leq 400$	criterion holds for $n \geq 295$	ratio $\leq 8.5 \cdot 10^{-13}$
(d) $\delta = -2$	integers, $n \leq 400$	criterion holds for $n \geq 297$	ratio $\leq 8.5 \cdot 10^{-13}$
(c)	$\mathbb{Q}[\delta]$ on $[-1, -0.772]$, $s \in [0.772, 1]$ $n \leq 400$	criterion holds for $n \geq 372$	ratio $\leq 4.3 \cdot 10^{-26}$

For (a) and (d), the dominant term at each residue class modulo 16 is the $k = 8$ term, or the $k = 16$ term where the $k = 8$ amplitude vanishes ($n \equiv 2, 6$ for $\delta = 2$; $n \equiv 0, 4 \pmod{8}$ for $\delta = -2$), with the signs of the stated patterns; the exact coefficients for $n \leq 400$ follow the patterns, with the single zero $c_{-2}(8) = 0$. For (c), the finite check divides $c_\delta(n)$ by $\delta + 1$ at the

100 indices $n \equiv 3 \pmod{4}$ where $c_{-1}(n) = 0$, and $c_\delta(4)$ additionally by $\delta^2 - 7\delta - 6 = (\delta - b)(\delta - b')$, which is non-negative on $[-1, b]$; Descartes' rule with bisection then certifies the signs on the closed interval. This proves Theorem 1.7. $\square$

8. FORCED ZEROS AND EXACT VANISHING

- The zeros of G_7^δ at $\delta = 1$ (residues 3, 4, 6) and of G_{11} at $\delta = 1$ (residues 3, 6, 8, 9, 10) follow from Euler's pentagonal number theorem: $m(3m - 1)/2$ avoids these residues, and $(q^p; q^p)_\infty$ is a series in q^p .
- The zeros at $\delta = 3$ (residues 2, 4, 5 for G_7 , and 2, 5, 7, 8, 9 for G_{11}) follow in the same way from Jacobi's identity $(q; q)_\infty^3 = \sum (-1)^m (2m + 1) q^{m(m+1)/2}$; see also [9, Cor. 13].
- For $Q_{12}^{\pm 1}$ the zeros at $n \equiv 3 \pmod{6}$, respectively $n \equiv 5 \pmod{6}$, are instances of the Andrews–Bressoud vanishing theorem [1].

9. TRANSFORMATION FORMULAE AND CUSP STRUCTURE FOR G_p AND Q_{12}

9.1. Borwein products. We use the transformation of [9, Prop. 7], which follows from the classical eta transformation. There is one correction: the auxiliary integer must satisfy $hh' \equiv -1 \pmod{k}$, the Hardy–Ramanujan convention, not $hh' \equiv 1$.

Let $\tau = h/k + iz/k^2$ and $d = \gcd(p, k)$. Then

$$G_p(e^{2\pi i \tau})^\delta = \left(\frac{p}{d}\right)^{\delta/2} e^{\pi i \delta (-s(h, k) + s(ph/d, k/d))} \exp\left(\frac{\pi \delta (d^2 - p)}{12pz} - \frac{(p-1)\pi \delta z}{12k^2}\right) \widehat{G}^\delta,$$

where

$$\widehat{G} = \frac{f(e^{2\pi i d h'_d/k - 2\pi d^2/(pz)})}{f(e^{2\pi i h'/k - 2\pi/z})}, \quad f(x) = \prod_{m \geq 1} (1 - x^m)^{-1},$$

and all powers are principal.

Lemma 9.1 (certified branch). *Consider every cusp h/k with $k \in \{7, 14, 21, 28\}$ for $p = 7$, or $k \in \{11, 22\}$ for $p = 11$. For each, the difference between $\log G_p(\tau)$, computed from its q -series, and the logarithm of the right-hand side, built from principal logarithms and the series for $\log f$, is $2\pi i \cdot 0$ on the connected set $\{\operatorname{Re} z > 0, \operatorname{Re}(1/z) \geq 1\}$.*

Proof. Both sides are continuous on this set, and their difference lies in $2\pi i \mathbb{Z}$, so it is constant. At $z = 1$ it was evaluated in 200-bit ball arithmetic, with explicit tail bounds, and has modulus at most 10^{-19} . With the convention $hh' \equiv +1$ the same difference is about $5.8 \cdot 10^{-4}$, which is not an integer; this confirms the corrected convention. $\square$

When $p \mid k$ we have $\widehat{G} = 1 - e(-h'/k)e^{-2\pi/z} + \dots$, with $hh' \equiv 1$ in this display. The main term grows like $e^{\pi \delta (p-1)/(12z)}$, and the correction term like $e^{\pi(\delta(p-1)/(12-2))/z}$. The correction term therefore grows exactly when $\delta > 24/(p-1)$; for $p = 7$ this means $\delta > 4$. When $p \nmid k$ the cusp is bounded:

$$|G_p^\delta| \leq K_p^\delta, \quad K_p = \sqrt{p} e^{-\pi(p-1)/(12p)} f(e^{-2\pi/p}) f(e^{-2\pi}),$$

so that $K_7 = 4.8195$ and $K_{11} = 13.734$.

9.2. The theta quotient Q_{12} . Put $\vartheta_c(\tau) = \sum_{J \equiv c(48)} e(\tau J^2/96)$. Then

$$Q_{12} = q^{-1} \frac{\vartheta_{10} - \vartheta_{14}}{\vartheta_2 - \vartheta_{22}}.$$

As in §3, the projective orbit of the pair of numerator and denominator under the Weil representation at level 96 was computed exactly in $\mathbb{Z}[\zeta_{192}]$, modulo $\Phi_{192} = x^{64} - x^{32} + 1$.

- The orbit has 48 elements and 10 cusp types.

- Exactly one type grows for $\delta > 0$. Its leading exponents are $(J_1, J_5) = (2, 10)$, its support is $J \equiv \pm 2, \pm 10 \pmod{24}$, and all its coefficients have equal modulus. Exactly one type grows for $\delta < 0$, namely the inverse type.
- An elementary Gauss-sum argument, as in Lemma 3.5, shows that growing cusps have $4 \mid k$. An exact check of all $k \leq 36$ gives: h/k grows iff $12 \mid k$ and $h \equiv 5, 7 \pmod{12}$ for $\delta > 0$, and $h \equiv 1, 11 \pmod{12}$ for $\delta < 0$.
- The suprema of $|R^{\pm 1}|$ over the bounded types on $\text{Im } \tau' \geq 1$ are at most $K_{12} = 550.75$ and $K'_{12} = 547.23$. These were certified by branch-and-bound.
- Exact Gauss sums and certified branch integers at the cusps of denominators 12 and 24 give the amplitudes below.

For $\delta > 0$ the growth is $e^{2\pi\delta/z}$ and the amplitudes are

$$\begin{aligned} 2 \cos \frac{5\pi n}{6} \text{ (main),} \quad & -2\delta \cos \frac{\pi(5n-1)}{6} \text{ (first correction),} \\ & \delta(\delta+1) \cos \frac{\pi(5n-2)}{6} \text{ (second correction).} \end{aligned}$$

For $\delta = -s < 0$ the amplitude at $k = 12$ is $2 \cos \frac{\pi(n-2s)}{6}$, and at $k = 24$ it is $2 \cos \frac{\pi(n-2s)}{12} + 2 \cos \frac{\pi(11n+2s)}{12}$.

10. EXPLICIT EXPANSIONS AND ERROR CONSTANTS FOR G_p AND Q_{12}

In every case the Rademacher dissection is carried out as in §4: Ford-circle arcs, chords of length at most $2\sqrt{2}k/(N+1)$, and $N \geq \sqrt{4\pi n} + 1$. The main terms have the shape $\mathcal{P}_k(B) = \frac{2\pi}{k} \sqrt{B/C} I_1(\frac{2\pi}{k} \sqrt{BC})$.

- For G_p : $B = \delta(p-1)/12$ for the main term, $B - 2$ for the correction term, and $C = 2n - \delta(p-1)/12$.
- For Q_{12} : $B = 2\delta, 2(\delta-1), 2(\delta-2)$ for the main term and the two corrections, and $C = 2(n+\delta)$.

The error is bounded by $\mathcal{E} = \mathcal{E}_{\text{arc}} + \mathcal{E}_{\text{rem}} + \mathcal{E}_{\text{ng}}$. For G_p these are

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{E}_{\text{arc}} &= \sqrt{2\pi} \frac{p-1}{p^2} e^{1+\pi\delta(p-1)/12} (1 + \delta e^{-2\pi[\cdot]}), \\ \mathcal{E}_{\text{rem}} &= 2\sqrt{2} \frac{p-1}{p^2} e^{1+\pi\delta(p-1)/12} (f(t)^\delta f(t^p)^\delta - 1 - \delta t[\cdot]), \\ \mathcal{E}_{\text{ng}} &= 2\sqrt{2} e K_p^\delta, \end{aligned}$$

with $t = e^{-2\pi}$, and where $[\cdot]$ means the term is included only when the correction is extracted, i.e. $\delta > 24/(p-1)$. For Q_{12} the analogues come from the majorant of the growing type. Typical values are $\mathcal{E} \approx 1.9 \cdot 10^4$ for G_7 at $\delta = 4.87$, and $\mathcal{E} \approx 1.6 \cdot 10^3$ for G_{11} at $\delta = 2$.

Lemma 10.1 (envelopes). *For $x > 0$, $\kappa(x_0)U(x) \leq I_1(x) \leq U(x)$ whenever $x \geq x_0$, where $U(x) = e^x/\sqrt{2\pi x}$ and $\kappa(x_0) = \sqrt{2\pi x_0} e^{-x_0} I_1(x_0)$ Lemma 5.2. Consequently, if every competitor term is bounded through U and the dominant term from below through κU , then each ratio competitor/dominant is at most $Cy^a e^{-gy}$ with $y = \sqrt{C}$ and a gap $g > 0$. Such a bound is decreasing for $y \geq a/g$. Hence a single verification at $n = n_1$ proves the inequality for every $n \geq n_1$.*

All dominance certificates below are of this form. In each, the gaps satisfy $g \geq 0.1$, the exponents satisfy $a \leq 3$, and $y(n_1) \geq 30$.

11. PROOF OF THEOREM 1.8

Throughout this section $p = 7$. The main-term amplitude at a cusp of denominator k ($7 \mid k$) is

$$a_k(n, \delta) = \sum_h \cos(-\pi\delta\sigma_h - 2\pi hn/k), \quad \sigma_h = s(h, k) - s(h, k/7),$$

and the correction amplitude is

$$b_k(n, \delta) = -\delta \sum_h \cos(-\pi\delta\sigma_h - 2\pi hn/k - 2\pi h'/k), \quad hh' \equiv 1 \pmod{k}.$$

Both sums run over the $\varphi(k) \leq 6k/7$ residues h coprime to k . With $B = \delta/2$, $B_2 = \delta/2 - 2$ and $C = 2n - \delta/2$, Lemma 10.1 and the expansion of §4 give

$$(10) \quad c_\delta(n) = \sum_{7 \mid k \leq N} \left(a_k(n, \delta) \mathcal{P}_k(B) + [\delta > 4] b_k(n, \delta) \mathcal{P}_k(B_2) \right) + E, \quad |E| \leq \mathcal{E}(\delta).$$

11.1. Auxiliary bounds.

Lemma 11.1. *Let $7 \mid k$ and let s lie in a compact subinterval of $(0, 5]$.*

- (a) $|\sigma_h| < k/12 + k/84 \leq k/10.5$. Hence $|\partial_s(\pi s \sigma_h)| \leq \pi k/10$, and $|\partial_s a_k| \leq \pi k \varphi(k)/10$.
- (b) On every Farey chord of order N , $|\operatorname{Im} \log G_7| \leq 0.556N^2$. Moreover $|\log |G_7|| \leq \log K_7 + 0.449N^2 + 2$ at non-growing cusps.
- (c) (arc lemma) Let $A_s = \int_{\text{arc}} \Phi(s) \exp(\pi s/(2z) + \pi(2n - s/2)z/k^2) dz$, taken over either small arc of K from 0. Then

$$|\partial_s A_s| \leq e^{1+\pi s/2} \left[\frac{\pi k}{10} \cdot \frac{\pi}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot \frac{k}{N+1} + \frac{2+\pi/2}{s/2} + \frac{\pi^2}{\sqrt{2}k(N+1)} \right].$$

The same bound holds for the correction integrand, with $s/2$ replaced by $s/2 - 2 > 0$ in the middle term and an extra factor $se^{-2\pi}$.

- (d) (Bessel derivative) With $x = \frac{2\pi}{k} \sqrt{BC}$,

$$|\partial_s \log \mathcal{P}_k| \leq D_k := \frac{1}{4B} + \frac{1}{4C} + \left(1 + \frac{1}{x}\right) \frac{2\pi}{k} \frac{\sqrt{C}}{4\sqrt{B}}.$$

Proof. (a) For $k \geq 2$ the classical bound $|s(h, k)| \leq (k-1)(k-2)/(12k)$ applies.

(b) Write $\log G_7 = \sum_{7 \nmid m} \log(1 - q^m)$ with principal logarithms, and use $|\operatorname{Arg}(1 - x)| \leq \frac{\pi}{2}|x|$ for $|x| < 1$. This gives $|\operatorname{Im} \log G_7| \leq \frac{\pi}{2}(1 - |q|)^{-1}$. On a chord $\operatorname{Re} z \geq k^2/(2N^2)$, so $1 - |q| \geq 0.9\pi/N^2$. For $\log |G_7|$, use the transformation formula at $d = 1$ together with $|\hat{G}| \in [(f(e^{-2\pi w/7})f(e^{-2\pi w}))^{-1}, f(e^{-2\pi w/7})f(e^{-2\pi w})]$, where $w = \operatorname{Re}(1/z) \leq 2N^2/k^2$.

(c) With $w = 1/z = 1 + iv$ one has $\partial_s f_s = (i\theta + \pi w/2 - \pi/(2k^2 w))f_s$, where $|\theta| \leq \pi k/10$ by (a). The terms $i\theta f_s$ and $\pi f_s/(2k^2 w)$ are bounded by the arc length times $e^{1+\pi s/2}$. For $\frac{\pi}{2} \int w f_s dz = -\frac{\pi}{2} \Phi i e^{\pi s/2} \int e^{i\pi s v/2} g(v) dv$, with $g = e^{b/(1+iv)}/(1+iv)$, integrate by parts exactly as in Lemma 7.2; this gives the factor $(2 + \pi/2)/(s/2)$.

(d) Differentiate $\log \mathcal{P}_k$ in s , using $I'_1/I_1 \leq 1 + 1/x$. The latter follows from $I_0 = I_2 + 2I_1/x \leq I_1 + 2I_1/x$. $\square$

Summing (c) over the growing cusps ($7 \mid k \leq N$, at most $6k/7$ of them for each k) introduces the harmonic factor $\sum_{7 \mid k \leq N} 1/k \leq \frac{1}{7}(1 + \log(N/7))$. The same summation over the chords, with lengths at most $2\sqrt{2}k/(N+1)$, bounds the derivative of the remaining error pieces:

- on chords at growing cusps, by $(|\theta| + \frac{\pi}{2}|1/z| + 0.1)(F_s - 1 - [\cdot]st) + F_s \ell_7 - [\cdot]t$, where $F_s = f(t)^s f(t^7)^s$, $\ell_7 = \log(f(t)f(t^7))$ and $|1/z| \leq 2N^2/k^2$;
- on chords at non-growing cusps, by K_7^s times the bound of (b).

Together this gives an explicit quantity $\mathcal{E}'(s, N) = O(N^3 \log N)$, which is implemented in `g7_deriv.py` and `g7_eps3.py`.

11.2. Steps of the proof. *Step 1 (exact small- n computations).* The exact polynomials $c_\delta(n) \in \mathbb{Q}[\delta]$ were computed for $n \leq 897$. Descartes' rule of signs, applied after the Möbius map of the interval to $(0, \infty)$ and with bisection, shows the following.

- On $[3, \delta_{\text{lo}}]$ every $c_\delta(n)$ has sign $\sigma(n \bmod 7)$ and no root. Where $c_3(n) = 0$, the factor $(\delta - 3)$ is first divided out exactly.
- On $[\delta_{\text{lo}}, \delta_{\text{hi}}]$ only $c_\delta(897)$ has a root, and it has exactly one. This defines δ_c .
- On $[2, 3]$ every $c_\delta(n)$ has the pattern $+- -++-$. Zeros at $\delta = 3$ are divided out, and the sign of the factor $(\delta - 3) \leq 0$ is taken into account.

Step 2 (dominance, $n \geq 898$). Let $J = [a, b]$ be a δ -interval, fix a residue r , and set $n_1 \geq 898$ with $n_1 \equiv r \pmod{7}$. The amplitude $a_7(r, \cdot)$ is enclosed on J in centred form, $a_7(r, m) + a'_7(r, J)(J - m)$, which is exact for linear functions. Suppose

$$\begin{aligned} \min_J |a_7(r, \delta)| \cdot \frac{2\pi}{7} \sqrt{\frac{a/2}{C_{\max}}} \kappa(x_1) U(x_1) &> [b > 4] 6b \mathcal{P}_7(B_2) \\ &+ \sum_{k=14, 21} \varphi(k) (\mathcal{P}_k(B) + b \mathcal{P}_k(B_2)) + \frac{N}{7} \cdot \frac{6N}{7} (1 + b) \mathcal{P}_{28}(B) + \mathcal{E}(b), \end{aligned}$$

where $x_1 = \frac{2\pi}{7} \sqrt{(a/2)C_{\min}}$, $C_{\min/\max} = 2n_1 - b/2$ resp. $2n_1 - a/2$, and $B = b/2$ on the right. where every $\mathcal{P}$ on the right is replaced by its upper envelope. Then $\text{sgn } c_\delta(n) = \text{sgn } a_7(r, \delta)$ for all $\delta \in J$ and all $n \geq n_1$ with $n \equiv r \pmod{7}$, by Lemma 10.1. Adaptive bisection certifies this on

$$[2, 3 - 10^{-9}], \quad [3 + 10^{-9}, 4.87], \quad [4.87, 4.87350758538]$$

with $n_1 = 898$, and on the window $W = [4.87350758538, \delta_c]$ for all residues $r \neq 1$ with $n_1 = 898$, and for $r = 1$ with $n_1 = 2500$.

Step 3 (near $\delta = 3$).

Proposition 11.2. *Let $r \in \{2, 4, 5\}$ and $0 < |\delta - 3| \leq 10^{-9}$. Then for every $n \geq 898$ with $n \equiv r \pmod{7}$, $\text{sgn } c_\delta(n) = \text{sgn } ((\delta - 3) a'_7(r, 3))$, which is the conjectured sign on each side of 3.*

Proof. By §8, $c_3(n) = 0$, and $a_7(r, 3) = 0$ exactly; the latter was checked in $\mathbb{Z}[\zeta_{28}]$. Subtract (10) at δ and at 3, with the same N . The $k = 7$ term becomes $a_7(r, \delta) \mathcal{P}_7(\delta/2)$, and

$$|a_7(r, \delta)| \geq |\delta - 3| \left(|a'_7(r, 3)| - |\delta - 3| \sum_h (\pi \sigma_h)^2 \right).$$

Every other difference is at most $|\delta - 3|$ times a bound from Lemma 11.1: for $k \geq 14$ this is $\varphi(k)(\pi k/10 + D_k) \mathcal{P}_k$, and for the error it is $\mathcal{E}'(s, N)$. Dividing by $|\delta - 3|$ gives a sufficient inequality that no longer involves $\delta - 3$. In envelope form it is certified at $n_1 = 898$ with margin at least $6.7 \cdot 10^8$ on both sides of 3, and by Lemma 10.1 it then holds for all $n \geq 898$. $\square$

The residues 0, 1, 3, 6 with $|\delta - 3| \leq 10^{-9}$ are covered by Step 2.

Step 4 (the window, residue 1, $898 \leq n < 2500$).

Proposition 11.3. *For every $n \geq 898$ with $n \equiv 1 \pmod{7}$ and every $\delta \in [4.87350758538, \delta_{\text{hi}}]$, we have $\partial_\delta c_\delta(n) > 0$.*

Proof. Differentiate (10). The dominant contribution is $a'_7(1, \delta) \mathcal{P}_7(\delta/2)$, where $a'_7(1, \delta) > 0.15$ on the interval. Against it:

- the term $|a_7(1, \delta)| |\partial_s \mathcal{P}_7|$, with $|a_7(1, \delta)| \leq 10^{-11}$ on the interval; its ratio to the dominant term is bounded by its value at $n = 2500$;
- the correction at $k = 7$, whose amplitude derivative is at most $6 + 6\delta\pi \cdot \frac{5}{14}$;
- the terms with $k \geq 14$;
- $\mathcal{E}'$.

The resulting inequality is certified in envelope form at $n_1 = 898$ with margin $3.6 \cdot 10^{10}$. $\square$

The values $c_{\delta_{\text{hi}}}(n)$ are certified negative for all $n \leq 7000$ with $n \equiv 1 \pmod{7}$, $n \neq 897$; this used a 3000-bit ball recurrence. For $898 \leq n < 2500$, $n \equiv 1 \pmod{7}$, Proposition 11.3 then gives $c_\delta(n) < c_{\delta_{\text{hi}}}(n) < 0$ for all $\delta \in [4.87350758538, \delta_c]$. For $n \geq 2500$, Step 2 applies.

Step 5 ($\delta = 1, 3, 5$). This is Step 2 at a single point with $n_1 = 400$, together with exact integer coefficients for $n \leq 400$. At $\delta = 5$, $a_k(r, 5) = 0$ for $k = 7, 14, 21$ and $r \equiv 1, 2, 6 \pmod{7}$, exactly. There the dominant term is $b_7(r, 5)\mathcal{P}_7(1/2)$, whose Bessel argument $\frac{2\pi}{7}\sqrt{C/2}$ exceeds that of every remaining term.

Step 6 (failure on $(\delta_c, 5)$).

- For $\delta \in (\delta_c, \delta_{\text{hi}}]$, $c_\delta(897) > 0$, because δ_c is its only root in $[\delta_{\text{lo}}, \delta_{\text{hi}}]$.
- On $[\delta_{\text{hi}}, 4.87350758538675509]$, an interval containing δ^* , the exact polynomial $c_\delta(897)$ is positive at both endpoints and has no sign variation (Descartes count 0). So it is positive throughout.
- For $\delta \in (\delta^*, 5)$, $a_7(1, \delta) > 0$. By (10) and Lemma 10.1, $c_\delta(n) > 0$ for all sufficiently large $n \equiv 1 \pmod{7}$.

In every case the pattern requires a minus sign at such n . For instance, $c_{49/10}(57) > 0$ by exact rational arithmetic. $\square$

12. PROOF OF THEOREM 1.9

On $[\gamma, 2]$ the $k = 11$ amplitude has no zero, and the smallest amplitude occurs at residue 10 near γ . Dominance holds for all $n \geq 300$ on $[1.7584, 2]$. For $n \leq 310$ the exact polynomials have the pattern on $[\gamma, 2]$. For this check $c_\delta(21)$ is divided by its degree-18 irreducible factor, which vanishes at γ and has no other root in $[\gamma, 2]$, and the zeros at $\delta = 2$ are divided out exactly. For $\delta = 1, 3$ we use dominance for $n \geq 600$ and exact integers for $n \leq 600$; the forced zeros are those of §8. $\square$

13. PROOF OF THEOREM 1.10

$2 \leq \delta \leq 3$. The main amplitude $2 \cos(5\pi n/6)$ vanishes at $n \equiv 3, 9 \pmod{12}$. There the first correction, with amplitude $\mp \delta$, decides the sign. Its Bessel argument exceeds that of the $k = 24$ main term whenever $\delta > 4/3$, so no threshold phenomenon occurs. The criterion is verified explicitly for every $400 \leq n \leq 20000$ on 8 subintervals of δ ; the tail $n > 20000$ is handled on 40 subintervals; and exact polynomials cover $n \leq 400$.

$\delta = \pm 1$. Dominance for $n \geq 181$, exact integer coefficients for $n \leq 400$, and forced zeros by [1].

$-1 < \delta \leq \delta_1$. This is the argument of §7 with the following changes.

- The growing cusps are $h \equiv 1, 11 \pmod{12}$ with $12 \mid k$.
- The main-term Bessel data are $B = 2s$, $C = 2(n-s)$, and the amplitude is $2 \cos(\pi(n-2s)/6)$. Near $s = 1$ this equals $\mp 2 \sin(\pi\varepsilon/3)$ at $n \equiv 5, 11 \pmod{12}$.
- The phase bound is $|\theta_{h,k}| \leq k^2/2 + 0.01$, the minor-arc constant is K'_{12} , and the arc lemma carries the frequency $2\pi s$, which contributes the term $(2 + \pi/2)/s_0$.
- The chord bound is $(k^2/2 + 4\pi N^2/k^2 + 0.2)(\tilde{F}_1 - 1) + \tilde{F}_1 \ell$, and the non-growing derivative bound is $2\sqrt{2} e K'_{12} (\log K_{12} + 0.02 + 0.556 N^2)$.

Every sum over k is evaluated explicitly for each n (`q12.neg.py`), so no harmonic factor is lost. At $\delta = -1$ the coefficients with $n \equiv 5, 11 \pmod{12}$ vanish identically. The ε -difference criterion of §7 is uniform in $\varepsilon = \delta + 1 \in (0, 0.356]$. It is verified for $774 \leq n \leq 20000$, and the tail is handled analytically. Exact polynomials on $[-1, \delta_1^+]$ cover $n \leq 780$: the only root in the interval is that of $c_\delta(22)$ at δ_1 . Since $c_\delta(22)$ has the wrong sign on all of $(\delta_1, 0)$, the pattern fails there. $\square$

14. COMPUTATIONS

What the computations rely on. Every computational step belongs to one of three categories.

- (1) *Exact integer and rational arithmetic*, in Python integers and FLINT [12] polynomials: Propositions 3.2 and 3.3, Lemma 3.5, the Gauss sums in Lemma 3.7, and §5.5.
- (2) *Ball arithmetic*, in Arb [11] as provided by python-flint 0.9.0 with FLINT 3.6.0 and Python 3.12.3: Proposition 3.6, Lemma 3.8, §§5.3–5.4, and §6. Arb guarantees that each computed ball contains the exact value, and an inequality is accepted only when the whole ball satisfies it.
- (3) *Floating point*, used only for exploration and as hash keys in the orbit computation. Every match found through a hash key was confirmed exactly, and no conclusion depends on floating-point arithmetic.

Scripts.

statement	script
Lemma 3.1 (numerical sanity check)	<code>weil_check.py</code>
Propositions 3.2, 3.3	<code>orbit.py</code> , <code>cuspid_types.py</code>
Lemma 3.5	<code>cuspid_exact.py</code>
Proposition 3.6	<code>supK.py</code>
Lemma 3.7	<code>exact.py</code>
Lemma 3.8	<code>branch_cert.py</code>
Remark 4.5	<code>consts.py</code>
§5.3	<code>certify_mid.py</code>
§5.4	<code>tail_sc.py</code>
§5.5	<code>c3.py</code>
§6	<code>discert_sc.py</code>
Remark ($[\beta^+, 8/3]$, $n \leq 700$)	<code>c3.betaplus.py</code>
§7: negative-exponent cuspid data	<code>inv_exact.py</code> , <code>cuspid_exact_inv.py</code> , <code>supKinv.py</code>
§7: part (c)	<code>neg_certify.py</code> , <code>neg_tail772.py</code> , <code>neg_finite2.py</code>
§7: parts (a), (d)	<code>pm2_certify.py</code> , <code>pm2_tail.py</code> , <code>pm2_finite.py</code>
independent direct check of Theorem 1.6	<code>q8_lite.py</code> (or <code>q8_signcheck.py</code>)

The script `q8_lite.py` computes the coefficients of Q_8^δ directly from (1), by a divide-and-conquer evaluation with blocked ball-arithmetic convolutions, and does not use §§3–4. Its ball radii grow like $e^{2.5\sqrt{n}}$, so 2600 bits suffice at $n \approx 8.6 \times 10^5$, with a memory footprint below 1 GB. The older `q8_signcheck.py` uses the Newton exponential, whose radii grow like $e^{6.4\sqrt{n}}$, and needs 15–20 GB.

Conjectures 20, 23 and 24. All certified steps use either exact arithmetic (FLINT) or ball arithmetic (Arb), via python-flint 0.9.0. A table of scripts is included in the accompanying repository.

- *Heaviest runs.* The exact root isolations for G_7 with $n \leq 897$ took about 20 minutes per interval, and the computation of the degree-897 polynomials took 3 minutes.
- *Independent check.* As a check on the Descartes computations for G_7 on $[2, 3]$, a separate complex-root isolation was run for $n \leq 160$. It agrees.
- *Mathematical inputs.* For Conjectures 20, 23 and 24 the only additional inputs are the classical eta transformation (with the corrected convention, certified in Lemma 9.1), Euler's and Jacobi's identities, and [1].

Independent verification. Every exact computation and every analytic bound was re-checked independently of the code that produced it. The corresponding scripts and logs are in `verification/` and are summarised in `REVIEW.md` in the repository.

- (1) *Second implementation of the exact checks.* The finite sign checks were re-implemented in PARI/GP 2.15.4. This implementation shares no code with the original and uses a different algorithm: integer-scaled polynomials $n!c_\delta(n) \in \mathbb{Z}[\delta]$ and Sturm root counting, instead of Descartes' rule with bisection. It reproduces every finite result used above:
 - Q_8 on $[8/3, 4]$ and on $[\beta^+, 8/3]$ for $n \leq 700$, and on $[-1, -0.772]$ for $n \leq 400$;
 - Q_{12} on $[2, 3]$ for $n \leq 400$, and on $[-1, \delta_1^+]$ for $n \leq 780$, where only $n = 22$ has a root;
 - G_{11} on $[\gamma, 2]$ for $n \leq 310$;
 - G_7 on $[2, 3]$ and on $[3, \delta_{lo}]$ for $n \leq 897$, and on $[\delta_{lo}, \delta_{hi}]$, where only $c_\delta(897)$ has a root, and it has exactly one.

The exact cusp typing was also re-implemented (Gauss sums reduced modulo Φ_M). It agrees for all 490 cusps of Q_8 with $k \leq 40$ and for all cusps of Q_{12} with $k \leq 36$.

- (2) *Audit of the analytic bounds.* Each bound was compared with exact data, so that a wrong bound would show up as a ratio exceeding 1. The largest ratios observed are:
 - 0.85 (chord length) and 0.75 (arc length) for the Farey lemma, over all fractions of orders $N \leq 59$ and $N = 97, 150, 211$; the bound on $\operatorname{Re} z$ is attained with equality, and $\min \operatorname{Re}(1/z) = 1$ on the chords;
 - 0.078 (Q_8), 0.028 (G_7), $1.6 \cdot 10^{-4}$ (Q_{12}) and 0.010 (G_{11}) for the explicit expansions with their error bounds;
 - $3.4 \cdot 10^{-6}$ for the derivative error bound in the G_7 window;
 - $1.1 \cdot 10^{-5}$ for the ε -difference bound for Q_8 near $\delta = -1$.
- (3) *The hypothesis of Lemma 10.1.* A script checks $g > 0$ and $y(n_1) \geq a/g$, with $a = 5$, for every dominance and derivative certificate; all cases pass.

The review found one error: the harmonic factor $\sum_{7|k \leq N} 1/k$ was missing from the G_7 arc-derivative estimate. It is included in the statements above, and all affected certificates were recomputed.

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